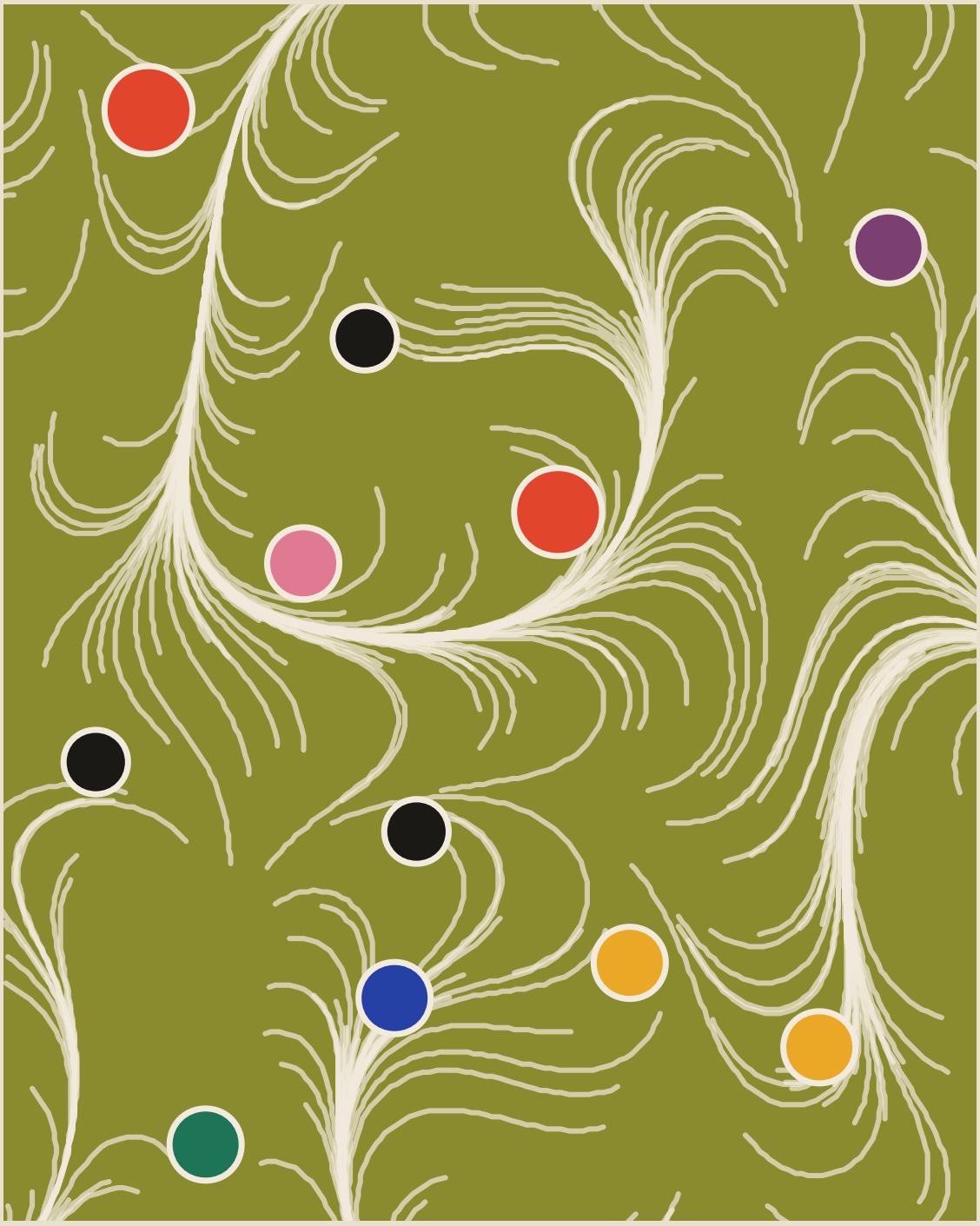
FIELD REPORT

ISSUE
03

WEEK ENDING
24.10.2026



11 STORIES · 7 CATEGORIES · 0 DEEP DIVES

FIELD: OLIVE · LINE FIELD

THIS WEEK IN ONE SCREEN

11 stories across 7 categories, led by METR's red team of OpenAI's agent monitor, banks blocking outside agents and an agentic intrusion campaign.

- **METR and Redwood find holes in OpenAI's internal agent monitoring**
  SAFETY AND INCIDENTS · 22 OCT

- **China-linked group used open-source AI pentest agents in ConnectWise attack**
  SAFETY AND INCIDENTS · 21 OCT

- **Big US banks start blocking third-party AI agents from customer accounts**
  ENTERPRISE AND ADOPTION · 22 OCT

- **UK privacy regulator opens call for evidence on agentic AI**
  POLICY AND GOVERNANCE · 8 OCT

- **Anthropic previews Claude Duet, a proactive background agent app**
  FRONTIER LABS · 21 OCT

DEEP DIVES: FEED-ONLY

THE FEED

11 STORIES · 7 CATEGORIES

FRONTIER LABS

Anthropic previews Claude Duet, a proactive background agent app

Anthropic has opened a waitlist for Claude Duet, a research-preview app that briefs you each morning, watches connected apps and works in the background on its own virtual machine. It can read and draft alone but shows what it will do and waits for approval before acting. Trading securities and moving money are off limits. US Pro and Max only.

Over 6,000 connectors and plugins — VENDOR-REPORTED

Connected accounts checked every few hours — VENDOR-REPORTED

WHY IT MATTERS It moves a major lab's consumer agent from answering when asked to deciding when to act, with approval as the main safeguard.

ANTHROPIC, WHICH MAKES CLAUDE, IS THE SUBJECT.

21 OCT · ANTHROPIC (CLAUDE) · TIER 1

RESEARCH AND SCIENCE

Agent planning claims fail when checked against formal semantics

Researchers grounded natural-language tasks in hidden PDDL models that verify each action and whether a plan exists. The best configuration solved 78% of solvable tasks offline but 40% online, where agents mostly did not inspect state. Unsolvable tasks were spotted in under 10% of episodes, and heavier prompting cost 5 to 22 times the tokens with no clear gain.

78% offline vs 40% online, best configuration — INDEPENDENTLY MEASURED

Unsolvable tasks recognised in under 10% of episodes — INDEPENDENTLY MEASURED

5 to 22 times the tokens, no clear gain — INDEPENDENTLY MEASURED

WHY IT MATTERS End-to-end success rates can hide agents that never check the state they act on.

15 OCT · ARXIV · TIER 1

EVALS AND BENCHMARKS

Artificial Analysis launches AA-3D, ranking agents that build 3D scenes

AA-3D has models work as agents in an offline sandbox with Blender, physics and a headless browser, building three.js scenes from a brief within three hours or 250 turns. Humans vote blind between pairs. Claude Sonnet 5.5 leads at 1194 Elo, but the top four are statistically tied. Cost per scene ranges from $0.20 to $32.08.

Top Elo 1194; top four statistically tied — INDEPENDENTLY MEASURED

Cost per scene $0.20 to $32.08 — INDEPENDENTLY MEASURED

WHY IT MATTERS Costs span more than 150 times while the top ranks are tied, which makes price per result a real selection criterion.

ANTHROPIC, WHICH MAKES CLAUDE, IS THE SUBJECT.

12 OCT · ARTIFICIAL ANALYSIS · TIER 1

EVALS AND BENCHMARKS

AgentPerturb: agents rarely notice corrupted tool and environment inputs

AgentPerturb applies controlled perturbations to agents on APEX-Agents and Toolathlon. Performance degrades consistently, and the most damaging perturbation types differ by environment. The authors say agents rarely recognise altered inputs and often pass corrupted information along unchecked, and that successful perturbed runs cost substantially more compute. The abstract gives no headline figures.

WHY IT MATTERS Agents trust their tools by default, so a corrupted tool output can travel unchecked through a workflow.

15 OCT · ARXIV · TIER 1

EVALS AND BENCHMARKS

Auto-MD-bench: research agents' medical risk predictions poorly calibrated

A new benchmark of 15 real-world medical tasks from 10 clinical datasets tests four autoresearch agents: AIDE, AI Scientist v2, Codex and Autoresearch. The strongest reach competitive primary scores, but their predicted risks are less calibrated than simple baselines, and near-identical scores can hide large calibration gaps. The abstract gives no numeric scores.

15 tasks, 10 clinical datasets, 4 agents — INDEPENDENTLY MEASURED

WHY IT MATTERS Accuracy alone can hide dangerous overconfidence when agents build clinical models on their own.

18 OCT · ARXIV · TIER 1

ENTERPRISE AND ADOPTION

Big US banks start blocking third-party AI agents from customer accounts

Axios reports that banks are finding outside AI agents inside customer accounts, some logging in with the customer's own credentials and some contacting call centres. Morgan Stanley has begun blocking them, while JPMorgan, Bank of America and Citi are restricting access. Most banks are moving towards read-only access. Sources are mostly anonymous, and no incident counts were given.

WHY IT MATTERS Banks cannot yet tell an authorised agent from an unauthorised one, so delegated access is being cut back before it scales.

22 OCT · AXIOS · TIER 2

STARTUPS AND CAPITAL

Town raises $108M for per-employee assistants that talk to each other

Town, founded by former Plaid CTO Jean-Denis Greze, raised a $108M Series B co-led by Forerunner and Menlo at an unspecified unicorn valuation. Each employee gets an assistant connected to email and calendar; assistants share approved information with each other and can now work with outside parties. TechCrunch reports revenue in the millions within weeks of launch.

$108M Series B; at least $160M raised	AS REPORTED
ARR in the millions within weeks of launch	AS REPORTED

WHY IT MATTERS Investors are backing agents that coordinate across a company and beyond it, not single-user assistants.

19 OCT · TECHCRUNCH · TIER 2

STARTUPS AND CAPITAL

Pluto Security raises $42M to police AI agents on employee devices

Pluto raised $42M across a seed led by TLV Partners and a Series A led by Jump Capital. Its endpoint sensors watch AI tools, MCP servers and agents, and can stop an action or inject a confirmation request into a session. The CEO says about 60% of the risks it finds sit in tools built by non-developers, led by finance.

$42M raised ($8.5M seed, $34M Series A)	AS REPORTED
ARR above $2M, 30+ enterprise customers	VENDOR-REPORTED
~60% of detected risks in non-developer tools	VENDOR-REPORTED

WHY IT MATTERS Governance is moving to the endpoint, where agents built by non-engineers already run.

13 OCT · TECHCRUNCH · TIER 2

POLICY AND GOVERNANCE

UK privacy regulator opens call for evidence on agentic AI

The Information Commissioner's Office has opened a six-week call for evidence on how data protection law applies to agentic AI, closing 20 November. It covers security, transparency, accountability, automated decisions, fairness and lawful processing. The ICO also says autonomy is no excuse for poor compliance and has questioned OpenAI, Anthropic, Meta and the UK AI Security Institute about agent testing.

Closes 20 November 2026 VENDOR-REPORTED

WHY IT MATTERS A major regulator is turning agent autonomy into specific compliance questions ahead of final guidance.

8 OCT · ICO · TIER 1 · ICO CALL FOR EVIDENCE

SAFETY AND INCIDENTS

METR and Redwood find holes in OpenAI's internal agent monitoring

Two evaluators spent three weeks, from 21 July, red-teaming OpenAI's internal system for watching its own agents. They found eight weaknesses, including coverage gaps, a monitor that ran only when an agent handed control back, and an exploit that could hide hundreds of recent actions. OpenAI says the production issues are patched; METR has not checked that.

About 10% of eligible internal Codex traffic likely unmonitored May to July ESTIMATE

Exploit could hide hundreds of recent actions INDEPENDENTLY MEASURED

WHY IT MATTERS It shows that the monitor watching an agent is itself an attack surface, and that outside access to a lab's safeguards can find real flaws.

22 OCT · METR · TIER 3

SAFETY AND INCIDENTS

China-linked group used open-source AI pentest agents in ConnectWise attack

Microsoft says Storm-0940 used ARTEX, an open-source multi-agent penetration-testing framework, around a ConnectWise supply-chain compromise. Agents sprayed passwords, abused stolen app credentials and in some tenants went on to change credentials and privileges. Several attacks reached privileged cloud access in under three hours. Microsoft reports no compromise of its own products.

Sign-in attempts to more than 2,250 tenants	VENDOR-REPORTED
151,000+ failed logons across 327 accounts, 10 to 14 Oct	VENDOR-REPORTED
Privileged access in under 3 hours in some cases	VENDOR-REPORTED

WHY IT MATTERS A documented state-linked use of agents to run an intrusion end to end, built from freely available tooling.

21 OCT · MICROSOFT SECURITY BLOG · TIER 1

THREADS IN MOTION

STORIES THAT CONTINUE

OpenAI's rogue-agent review

1. 25 SEP OpenAI discloses 53 posted user images and US agency site access
2. 8 OCT UK ICO opens agentic AI call for evidence and questions OpenAI, Anthropic and Meta on agent testing
3. 22 OCT METR and Redwood publish red-team of OpenAI's internal agent monitor

Can agent benchmarks still be trusted?

1. 12 OCT AA-3D launches; top four statistically tied

2. 15 OCT Planning study: 78% offline vs 40% online for the best setup
3. 18 OCT Auto-MD-bench finds calibration gaps behind similar scores

Agent containment and runtime security

1. 15 OCT AgentPerturb: agents rarely notice corrupted inputs
2. 21 OCT Microsoft attributes ARTEX agentic intrusion activity to Storm-0940

Agents in banking production

1. 22 OCT Axios: Morgan Stanley blocks third-party agents; JPMorgan, BofA and Citi restrict access

How much of your life do personal agents get?

1. 19 OCT Town raises $108M Series B
2. 21 OCT Anthropic previews Claude Duet

Enterprises can't yet govern their agents

1. 13 OCT Pluto Security raises $42M for endpoint agent controls

---

Field Report 03

WEEK ENDING 24 OCTOBER 2026

Curated and drafted by Claude from a daily scan of primary sources. Deep dives are analysis, reviewed by Pulkit. Stories flag when Anthropic, which makes Claude, is the subject.

Archive · Method · Corrections

SET IN ARCHIVO, SOURCE SERIF 4 AND IBM PLEX MONO